Cowabunga SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

THU OCT 15, 2026 DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · THU OCT 15 · NORTH PB

Glassy and a little smaller. Little Point, done by 9:15.



Gerry Lopez at Uluwatu, 1974 · Photo: Dana Edmunds · post by Patagonia (@patagonia) · view on X

the S swell is still running: paddle out by 7:15

PADDLE OUT BY	7:00	BOARD Inferno 72 ~70°F WATER

What's in the water

3–5 FT, SETS 6 (SRF)

GROUND

SwH 3.0 ft · 15s

WINDSWELL

WWH 2.3 ft · 8s

HS BUOY

Hs 3.9 ft · 46258



FROM

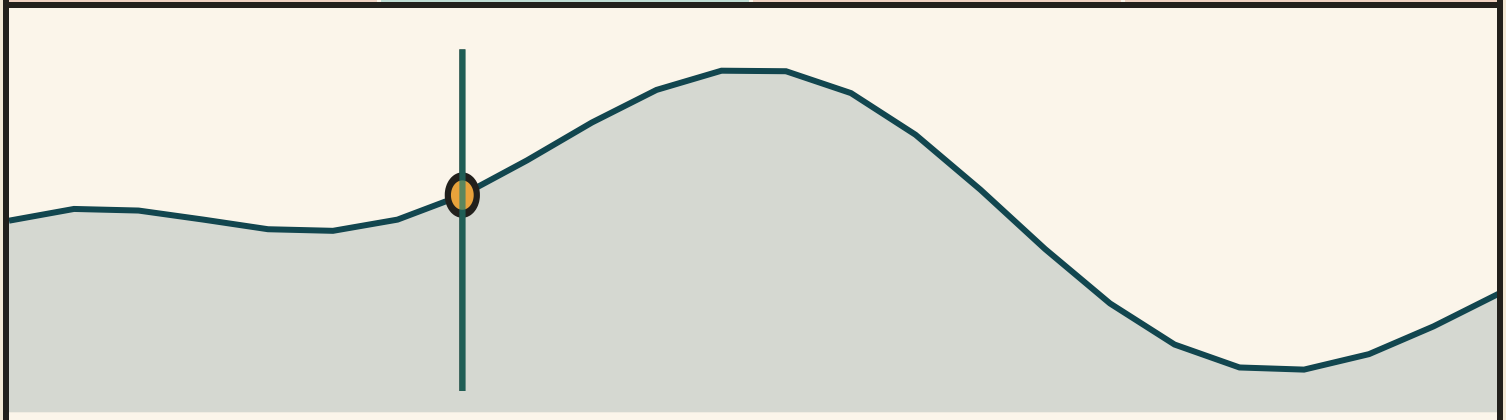
202° SSW

Buoy 46258 spectrum · ground 3.0 ft @ 15s SSW (14–15s overnight) + WWH 2.3 ft @ 8s WNW · face 3–5 ft, sets 6 (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 3 ft @ 15s + W 1 ft @ 13s · MWD 202° SSW · wind calm to light NE

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

PRE-7A · FIRST LIGHT	7–9:15A · LITTLE POINT	9:30A–2P FLOOD	AFTERNOON · N 10 MPH
WAIT	GO	SKIP	SKIP



7:00a	GO · Little Point	3.3 ft tide	NE ~4 kt · NWS	3–5 ft, sets 6 (SRF)

L 2.8 @ 4:40a · H 5.1 @ 11:29a · L 0.8 @ 7:37p · obs 4.1 @ 6:42a

Little Point, 7 to about 9:15a, on the Inferno 72. The table has L 2.8@4:40a rising to H 5.1@11:29a, but the gauge read 4.12 ft at 6:42a against about 3.2 predicted, so it is still running roughly 0.9 ft over the table. That puts the reef past its 5.5 ft ceiling around 9:15a, and the real high could reach about 6 ft. The pier anemometers (LJAC1 and NOAA 9410230) have been calm to E 1–3 kt since midnight. NWS hourly holds NE 5 mph (~4 kt) through 8a, N 5 mph 9 to 10a, NW 5

mph 11a to noon, then N 10 mph (~9 kt) from 1p. No good afternoon backup: the tide drains under N wind and hits its low at 7:37p, after sunset. Sunrise 6:52a, sunset 6:17p.

Where it's working

★

Little Point

Top of the scorecard at 0.98. SSW groundswell (46258 SwH 3.0 ft @ 15s, 194–225° overnight) sits right in its window, the pier is calm to light E since midnight, and the tide is rising through the middle. The gauge read 4.12 ft at 6:42a, about 0.9 ft over the table, so the reef reaches its 5.5 ft ceiling around 9:15a. Paddle out by 7:15.

CALL

2

PB Drive

Score 0.94. Also fine on the same light NE wind if Little Point is packed. Softer sandbar peaks, and the sets to 6 ft will close out some.

ALSO

3

Calumet

Score 0.87. Good swell angle, but it wants less water than this flooding high. Pass.

SOFT

4

Tourmaline

Score 0.85. Rideable, but too full for the cobble as the tide pushes toward the 11:29a high.

SOFT

5

PB north of the pier

Score 0.72. The SSW angle mostly misses the pier wedge, so it is smaller and less organized than Drive.

SOFT

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Skip · PB Point (0.43) is undersized for its band on a thin 3 ft groundswell and too full on this tide. The Cliffs (Garbage, Abs, Luscomb's) want W groundswell and a lower tide, and today is SSW on a flooding high, so none of them beat Little Point. OB is the same story. Scripps and Blacks are extended only and do not top a local reef on offshore SSW.

SKIP

BOARD

Inferno 72

~70°F

QUIVER

Sharp Eye Inferno 72

Clean 15-second groundswell on a steep reef left with glassy wind. Still Inferno territory, even a bit smaller than yesterday.

Anvil twin · only if you end up on the Drive sandbar
TW log · too much push for it today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Watch the gauge, not just the table.

Tide tables only predict the pull of the moon and sun. Warm water, low pressure, and swell can lift the real sea level above that, and the La Jolla gauge has run close to a foot high all week. On a shallow reef with a tide ceiling, that foot moves your window up by about 40 minutes.

SKIP

Little Point after about 9:15a, when the high tide goes over its ceiling, and again in the afternoon as it drains under N wind. Everything from 9:30a to 2p while it is flooded. Calumet, Tourmo, and PB Point on this high. The Cliffs and OB on a SSW swell.

GOTCHAS

Little Point is a shallow reef with a tight takeoff, so it crowds fast and the rocks show as it drains. High rip current risk and a Beach Hazards Statement through 2p today (NWS). Sets to 6 ft at 15 seconds mean long lulls, then a big set. A Heat Advisory runs 10a today through 8p Saturday, so bring water for the stairs at Fern Glen.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL: Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES

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